

Career Chart After 12th: Commerce

With and without Maths: BBA, B.Com, CA, law and design routes

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Commerce keeps business, finance, law and design open. Maths decides how many quantitative doors stay open.

Commerce at a glance

Commerce · With or without Maths

- B.Com and BA Economics, then CA, CS or CMA
- BBA, BMS, integrated MBA (IPMAT, JIPMAT)
- Integrated law: CLAT and other law tests
- BCA and data routes (Maths helps)
- Banking, insurance and finance jobs after graduation

With and without Maths

Commerce with Maths

- Keeps BCA, data, economics honours and quantitative finance open.
- Strengthens CUET scores in Mathematics and Economics-linked papers.
- Fits actuarial and analytics routes better than commerce without Maths.
- Still lets you register for CA Foundation, CS and CMA.

Commerce without Maths

- Not a dead end. B.Com, BBA, law, design, mass communication and CA remain open.
- Check BCA and quantitative degrees college by college. Many ask for Maths or a bridge course; some accept any stream.
- Learn spreadsheets and basic data reading during the degree. That gap is fixable.
- Pair the degree with one applied skill: sales, accounting software, marketing or finance modelling.

Commerce routes row by row

ROUTE	WHO CAN APPLY	ENTRY GATE	LENGTH	PAY SIGNAL	THE CATCH
BCA, BSc Computer Science or data science	Most colleges want Maths or Computer Science in 12th; check each one	CUET UG or a college test	3 years (4 in many four-year honours programmes)	Data analyst fresher pay averages about ₹4.1 lakh	Cheaper than B.Tech, but the degree carries less brand weight, so proof of work matters more.
BBA, BMS or integrated MBA	Any stream	CUET UG, IPMAT, JIPMAT or a college test	3 to 5 years	Wide range. Entry-level digital marketing managers average about ₹3.1 lakh in PayScale profiles and it rises with results	A general management degree without one domain skill produces a generalist gap.
B.Com or BA Economics with CA, CS or CMA	Any stream can register for CA Foundation	CA Foundation twice a year; CS and CMA have their own entry exams	CA usually takes several years with articleship	Accountant fresher pay averages about ₹2.3 lakh; a qualified CA earns far more	Many students spend years on repeat attempts. Keep a parallel skill running.
Integrated law (BA LLB, BBA LLB)	Any stream	CLAT (roughly 3,600 to 3,700 undergraduate seats across the participating NLUs), AILET, CUET and university tests	5 years	Litigation starts slowly; corporate and compliance roles pay more	Competition happens twice: first the entrance, then the climb to a strong practice or firm.
Design: B.Des, fashion, interior, UX	Any stream	UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT entrance and college tests	4 years	Graphic designer fresher pay averages about ₹2.4 lakh; a strong portfolio moves it up	Admission tests reward drawing and thinking speed. Prepare a portfolio early.

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What the first year pays

Software engineer		₹5.4 lakh
Data analyst		₹4.1 lakh
Digital marketing manager		₹3.1 lakh
Mechanical engineer		₹3.0 lakh
Registered nurse		₹2.6 lakh
Pharmacist		₹2.5 lakh
Graphic designer		₹2.4 lakh
Accountant		₹2.3 lakh

Exam dates to note

LAW

CLAT 2027: 6 December 2026

The exam runs from 2 pm to 4 pm in offline mode. Applications opened on 3 August and close on 31 October 2026, so this one is still open.

COMMERCE

CA Foundation: register by 1 January or 1 July

ICAI needs registration on or before 1 January for the May or June exam, and on or before 1 July for the November or December exam, with at least four months of study.

NOT ANNOUNCED

NEET UG 2027, CUET UG 2027 and the next NDA cycle

NTA's calendar for December 2026 to March 2027 does not list NEET UG or CUET UG. NDA II 2026 was held on 13 September 2026. Wait for each official notice before planning around a date.

Test every shortlisted route: 4 checkpoints, then 3 gates

1 Biology

How do you actually work best: abstract study, business thinking, people, or tools and systems? Choose the daily reality, not the label.

2 Context

Marks, money, family situation, school options, commute and emotional readiness. A route right on paper can be wrong for now.

3 Market

Where does the route lead later: real roles, real skills, real progression? Map it forward before you choose.

4 Survival

Will it hold up in an AI-shaped market? Domain skill plus communication, digital fluency and judgment lasts longer than routine work.

5 Proof of Skill

Complete one small real task that resembles the route before you lock it.

6 Proof of Communication

Explain in 30 to 90 seconds why the route fits you, where it leads and what you will test next.

7 Proof of Value

Get grounded feedback from a teacher, senior or professional who does this work, and pressure-test your reasoning.

Your one-page plan

Three routes I shortlisted:

The entry gate and date I verified, and where:

My second route if the exam goes badly:

One small real task I will finish this month:

Two people inside the route I will ask:

Read this first: Seat numbers, exam dates, fees and pay figures change every year and differ by state and college. Use this chart to compare routes, then confirm each date and rule on the official exam site before you act.

The route is the base layer. The skill portfolio on top raises your ceiling.
Check your fit with the free career assessments: futurecareerschool.com/services/assessments/
Personal help for you and your family: futurecareerschool.com/services/career-counselling-and-career-guidance/ · WhatsApp message from the site.
Full guide with explanations: futurecareerschool.com/blog/career-options/career-chart-after-12th/